AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES

EA300A
Children's Literature (I)
Main – All Branches
MIDTERM ASSESSMENT

2025-2026 / Spring Semester
Date: 14 April 2026
12:00 – 2:00

Number of Exam Pages: 4 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 2 hours**

INSTRUCTION

There are TWO sections in this exam paper:

1. You are required to answer two questions from Section 1, and One question from Section 2.
2. Answers in Section 1 should be in the form of short answers.
3. Answers in section 2 should be in standard essay format: Start with a thesis, end with a conclusion, define all important terms, and provide specific and appropriate examples. Analyze and discuss the examples.
4. Edit your answers, paying attention to grammar, punctuation, and spelling.
5. Cross out any notes you make which you do not want to be considered.
6. It is also necessary to refer to relevant critical essays to support your analysis.

CamScanner

SECTION 1: SHORT ANSWERS (10 marks)

Answer TWO of the following three questions in 50 words each.

1. **Drawing on J. Zipes, fairy tales are remembered because they can inspire change. Do stories actually empower change, or do they only emotionally comfort readers? (5 marks)**

2. **"In both versions of Cinderella, obedience and conformity are portrayed differently." Does the heroine succeed by compliance or resistance? (5 marks)**

3. **Examine the characterization of the Prince in Perrault and Dahl's Cinderella. What does each portrayal suggest about authority and desirability? (5 marks)**

SECTION 2: ESSAY WRITING/ CLOSE READING (20 MARKS)

Answer ONE of the following questions in an essay of 250 WORDS.

Question 1: ESSAY WRITING

"In Alcott's *Little Women*, Laurie is both privileged and emotionally vulnerable." Discuss the ways in which his wealth, social position, and loneliness shape his character and relationships with the March family. How does Alcott represent conventional models of nineteenth-century masculinity through him?

OR

CamScanner

Question 2: CLOSE READING

Analyse this passage from L. M. Alcott's *Little Women* focusing on the contrast between Jo and Meg's temperaments. Discuss the ways dialogue, imagery, and humor reveal the novel's treatment of sisterly tension and resilience in the face of poverty.

'If Marmee shook her fist instead of kissing her hand to us, it would serve us right, for more ungrateful wretches than we are, were never seen,' cried Jo, taking a remorseful satisfaction in the snowy walk and bitter wind.

'Don't use such dreadful expressions,' replied Meg from the depths of the veil in which she had shrouded herself like a nun sick of the world.

'I like good strong words that mean something,' replied Jo, catching her hat as it took a leap off her head preparatory to flying away altogether. 'Call yourself any names you like, but I am neither a rascal nor a wretch and I don't choose to be called so.'

'You're a blighted being, and decidedly cross today because you can't sit in the lap of luxury all the time. Poor dear, just wait till I make my fortune, and you shall revel in carriages and ice cream and high-heeled slippers, and posies, and red-headed boys to dance with.'

'How ridiculous you are, Jo!' But Meg laughed at the nonsense and felt better in spite of herself.

'Lucky for you I am, for if I put on crushed airs and tried to be dismal, as you do, we should be in a nice state. Thank goodness, I can always find something funny to keep me up. Don't croak any more, but come home jolly, there's a dear.'

Jo gave her sister an encouraging pat on the shoulder as they parted for the day, each going a different way, each hugging her little warm turnover, and each trying to be cheerful in spite of wintry weather, hard work, and the unsatisfied desires of pleasure-loving youth.

***Little Women* (1868) pp. 61-2**

End of Exam

CamScanner